coursera

Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Learn With PsycLearn Essentials

Module 2
Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Lesson 1: Culture and Mood Disorders

- ✓ Focus of the Course
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Classifying Psychopathology
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Culture and Psychopathology
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Culture and Intersectionality
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Culture and Stigma
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Check Your Understanding: Culture and Mood Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Lesson 2: Introduction to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

- ✓ Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Video • 6 min
- ✓ Living with a Mood Disorder: A Case Study
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Overview of Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Check Your Understanding: Introduction to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Key Takeaways: Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2 Quiz

- ✓ Module Quiz: Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Graded Assignment • Grade: 87.5%

Module 3
Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Lesson 3: Overview of Depressive Disorders

- ○ **Depression: A Case Study**
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ What Does Depression Feel Like?
  Reading • 7 min
- ○ Diagnostic Criteria and Prevalence for Depressive Disorders
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Check Your Understanding: Overview of Depressive Disorders
  Practice Assignment • 12 min

Lesson 4: Overview of Bipolar Disorders

- ○ Bipolar: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ What Does Bipolar Feel Like?
  Reading • 7 min
- ○ Diagnostic Criteria and Prevalence for Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Check Your Understanding: Overview of Bipolar Disorders
  Practice Assignment • 13 min

Key Takeaways

- ○ Key Takeaways: Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3 Quiz

- ○ Module Quiz: Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Graded Assignment • 16 min

Module 4
Biological Contributing Factors

Module 5
Psychological Contributing Factors

Module 6
Treatments for Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Module 7
Suicide

Module 8
Conclusion

Module 9
Cumulative Quiz

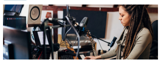
Module 10
Course Resources

Module 11
PsycLearn Essentials APA Student Resources

Depression: A Case Study

0:05 / 2:42 1x

Scenario



My name is S. I am a consultant but my dream is to be a professional musician. I was officially diagnosed with depression last year, but I think I've been struggling with it for much longer. Perhaps the recent pandemic along with stress in the office made things unbearably difficult that I finally decided to seek help…or should I say help found me.

I see myself as an introvert and keep to myself for the most part. I figured that I shouldn't speak up if I had nothing to contribute, or even if I had something to contribute, I'd much rather do it through text messages or email. I think I'm a decent conversationalist, but talking to people drains me. You'd think that being a consultant I'd enjoy the attention! After meeting clients or after giving a presentation, I usually go back to my office, lock the door, and decompress.

Now, the pandemic meant that I was working from home for most of the year. At first it was great. I had all the extra space and time to myself. But as work stress mounted I found it difficult to reach out to others…. I continued to work but I no longer felt excited or motivated and sadness took over my life. There were many sleepless nights and dreadful mornings--I was fatigued and felt overwhelmed and I forced myself to cry just to release some emotions. Soon it came to a point where I felt nothing. I felt numb. I was empty. My instruments were covered with a layer of dust. I didn't pick them up.

I checked in with my doctor sometime during the pandemic because I thought I had the virus. Sometime during our online visit he asked how I was feeling. I guess I was at my breaking point because I let everything out. The doctor didn't diagnose me at that point. He encouraged me to seek online therapy first. Things weren't improving very much even after about 2 months of online therapy. My therapist then encouraged me to discuss the possibility of going on some medication. Frankly, it was difficult for me to accept that suggestion. Medication for depression seemed like a stigma. Yet I knew that I couldn't go on that way.

Today, I feel better. Sure there are down days but I cope better. I'm benefiting from psychotherapy and a prescribed medication from my doctor and it has been helping. My instruments are no longer covered in dust because I'm enjoying time with friends to make music. I guess I'm sharing this story because depression is a hidden illness. There are probably more people who do not have a diagnosis and continue to struggle each day. I guess, if nothing else, we could all be kinder to people we meet, we've no idea what they might be going through.

End of Scenario

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